

AI Governance Starter Kit v1

Product: AI Governance Starter Kit

Version: 1.2.0

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This packet contains editable templates and reference PDFs for a combined first-pass AI governance and risk assessment file. Start with START-HERE.md, then adapt the DOCX files for your organization.

Included documents

Core governance records

1. AI Use Inventory

A field schema and starter template for tracking AI tools, owners, data use, risk tier, approval status, and review cadence.

2. AI Acceptable Use Policy

A practical internal policy template covering approved tools, prohibited uses, data handling, human review, disclosure, escalation, and acknowledgment.

3. AI Risk Intake and Impact Assessment

A structured intake and assessment form for proposed AI tools, workflows, material changes, and higher-risk uses.

4. AI Update Tracker

A change log template for model, prompt, vendor, system, policy, and workflow updates.

Readiness and rollout helpers

5. AI Readiness Checklist

A first-pass checklist for ownership, data rules, approved tools, review paths, rollout, higher-risk workflows, and update rhythm.

6. 30-Day AI Governance Setup Plan

A week-by-week implementation plan for turning the packet into an operating first pass.

7. Green / Yellow / Red AI Use Rules

A short staff-facing version of the AI use rules.

8. AI Tool Approval Mini-Checklist

A quick triage checklist for low-risk AI tool requests, with stop triggers for deeper review.

9. Team Rollout Message

Email, Slack/Teams, manager follow-up, FAQ, acknowledgment, and launch checklist language.

10. First AI Governance Meeting Agenda

A 30-minute and 60-minute agenda for the first governance review meeting.

11. What Good Looks Like

A completion scorecard and evidence-file checklist for the first setup pass.

Risk assessment tools

12. AI Risk Tiering Decision Tree

A tiering worksheet for deciding whether a use is low, medium, high, or paused/prohibited.

13. AI Risk Register Template

A living register for identified AI risks, owners, mitigations, residual scores, and review dates.

14. AI Risk Review Notes

A meeting/review notes template for documenting decisions, rationale, conditions, and follow-up actions.

Bonus materials

- **Bonus Filled Example: Small Business First Pass**

A completed fictional example showing the inventory, policy decisions, tiering, risk register, and update tracker in use at a small business.

- **Starter spreadsheets**

CSV versions of the AI Use Inventory, AI Risk Register, and AI Update Tracker for Excel, Google Sheets, or Airtable.

Folder structure

- markdown/ - editable Markdown source
- docx/ - Word-compatible editable documents
- pdf/ - PDF exports
- spreadsheets/ - CSV starter files for the inventory, risk register, and update tracker
- START-HERE.md - buyer-facing setup guide and recommended first pass
- LEGAL-NOTICE.md - educational-use and legal-boundary notice

Important legal boundary

These materials are educational templates and informational starting points only. They are not legal advice, do not create an attorney-client relationship, and do not guarantee compliance with any law, regulation, contract, or industry requirement.

Review and adapt these materials for your organization, industry, jurisdictions, contracts, and actual AI use. Consult qualified counsel before relying on them for legal compliance or regulated use cases.